PRE-CLASS PREP

Safety

Read this before class — it will make the lecture click faster.

🛡 Know Before You Go

Big picture: Patient safety is every nurse's primary responsibility. Today covers the regulatory framework (TJC/NPSG), event types, fall prevention, environmental emergencies, restraints, and home safety planning — all core to daily nursing practice.

TJC & NATIONAL PATIENT SAFETY GOALS

- **TJC:** impartial national organization that accredits hospitals based on safety performance; over 22,000 institutions accredited
- **NPSGs (since 2002):** identify safety practices health care institutions must consistently meet; over 250 standards of compliance
- Current goals: identify clients correctly · improve staff communication · use medications safely · use alarms safely · prevent HAIs · reduce suicide risk · universal protocol for surgery

UNEXPECTED EVENTS

Near Miss — potential error caught and avoided before reaching the patient

Patient Safety Event — unexpected event that occurred without patient injury

Sentinel Event — critical unexpected event causing severe harm, permanent injury, or death

- **Barriers to reporting:** fear of repercussions, time constraints, unclear policies, bullying, insufficient training
- All team members should be supported in reporting near misses and safety events

FALL RISK & PREVENTION

- Complete **Morse Fall Scale** each shift
- Yellow wrist band and yellow non-skid socks for fall risk patients
- Call light within reach — educate patient on use
- Bed low, locked, and call light accessible when leaving room
- Ensure adequate lighting; keep environment free of clutter
- Consider family involvement for high-risk patients

RESTRAINTS — LAST RESORT

- Clients have the right to care in the **least restrictive environment**
- **Try first:** diversional activities, de-escalation, room near nurses' station, family presence, bed/chair alarms, reorientation, concealing devices
- Indications: unsafe movement, removing medical devices, aggression, danger to self or others
- Types: mitten, elbow, lap belt, soft wrist, leather wrist, chemical
- Document: behavior requiring restraints, alternatives attempted, rationale, patient response, criteria for release; assess I&O, ROM, toileting

EMERGENCY RESPONSE

- **Fire (RACE):** Rescue, Alarm, Contain, Extinguish/Evacuate
- **Fire extinguisher (PASS):** Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep
- **Tornado:** move to inner hallway; no elevators; close doors; move beds from windows; cover client with blanket; shoes on clients
- **Active shooter (Run–Hide–Fight):** evacuate if clear path; hide and barricade if not; silence phone; fight only as last resort
- **Seizure:** turn on side; note start time; padded rails; O_2 and suction at bedside; AMBU bag nearby; bed low and locked; all rails up
- **Radiation:** minimize time near source; stay ≥6 ft away; use shielding

HOME SAFETY & DISCHARGE PLANNING